

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 585

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of James Rufus "JR"
Armstrong of Germantown.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of James Rufus "JR" Armstrong of Germantown; and

WHEREAS, JR Armstrong was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on October 6, 1935, in Memphis, Mr. Armstrong was the son of Chester Rufus Armstrong and Corryne Wood Armstrong; and

WHEREAS, on January 4, 1953, Mr. Armstrong married his loving wife, Ruth Joy Horne Armstrong, with whom he enjoyed seventy-three years marriage; and

WHEREAS, JR Armstrong worked for eighteen years at Charles Reed Buick and earned the title of leading salesman, a role he held for many years; and

WHEREAS, in 1972, Mr. Armstrong moved to Bolivar, where he purchased Bolivar Ford Motor Company; and

WHEREAS, along with his successful career as a salesman, Mr. Armstrong attended Jack Knox SS class, was a Jaycee in Memphis, and served as a member of Bolivar Rotary Club, which honored him as a Paul Harris Fellow; and

WHEREAS, JR Armstrong was deeply devoted to his faith and his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, JR Armstrong was an established member of Germantown Baptist Church and a former member of Bolivar First Baptist Church; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Armstrong is survived by his cherished wife, Ruth Joy Horne Armstrong; his sons, David Rufus (Jianling) Armstrong and Steven Wayne (Melissa Bolton) Armstrong; his

grandchildren, Michael (Amanda) Armstrong, Benjamin Armstrong, Robyn Mackenzie Mathis, and Taylor Mathis (Lee) Meek; his great-grandchildren, Marissa Brooke Watson, Wyatt Lee Meek, and Kate Riley Meek; his nephew, Richard (Laura) Armstrong; and a host of friends and colleagues; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, JR Armstrong was preceded in death by his stepmother, Louise Armstrong; his brother, Bobbie Armstrong; his stepbrother, Edwin Johnson; and his stepsister, Joann Russell; and

WHEREAS, the epitome of excellence, Mr. Armstrong was a faithful soul who impacted the lives of those who were blessed to know him, and he leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of James Rufus "JR" Armstrong, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Armstrong.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.